- The child is too weak to nurse or cannot because of harelip for cleft palate
- Breast milk has completely stopped or insufficient for the child
- Mother is not available to feed the child
- The mother is on anticoagulants, steroids and radioactive drugs,
- Death of the mother.

2.3.5 Weaning



Weaning begins from the moment supplementary food started and continue still the child is taken off the breast completely. The ideal time to start semi solid food is when a baby is ready to sit up, swallow and eat taste other foods, the baby's stomach is ready to digest food and the baby has good appetite and accepts food readily and there is no more activity in the child.

2.3.6 Types of supplementary foods

a) Liquid supplements

i. Milk

At about the sixth month of life the frequency of breastfeeding is reduced to three or four times per day and animal milk is substituted. Since the proportion of nutrients in animal milk differs from the human milk, the cow's milk is diluted with boiled and cooled water in the proportion of 2: 1 for the first feeds. The amount of water is gradually reduced so that in the course of a few weeks the baby receives undiluted animal milk. Two feeds, with 225 ml of milk per feed is an ideal replacement. Sugar can be added for taste and it to increase calories.

ii. Juice of fresh fruits

Oranges, tomatoes, sweet lime, grapes, serve to supplement the protective nutrients not present in sufficient amounts in breast milk as well as in animal milk. It is advantages to start feeding small quantities of fresh fruit juice even in the 3rd or 4th month of life.

iii. Soup from green leafy vegetables

In case fresh fruits are not available, green leafy vegetables may be used as an alternative. Strained soup can be given in the beginning with unstrained soup later on

b) Solid supplements

Mashed food is started around the 7th or 8th month of life. Around this time, the infant is already receiving animal milk, fruit juice or vegetable soup and fish liver oil.

i. Cereal and starchy gruels

To meet the increasing demands of calories and protein, well-cooked mashed cereal like rice, rice flour, rice flakes and ragi flour mixed with milk and sugar can be given. Addition of a small amount of vegetable oil to the porridge makes it less glutinous increasing the energy density.

ii. Vegetables

Cooked, Mashed vegetables like potato, green leafy vegetables and carrots can be introduced to get vitamins and minerals and colours in the diet

iii. Fruits

All fruits, with the exception of banana which is mashed, must be stewed and sieved for one year old baby. Thereafter, it is given simply stewed, with the addition of little sugar and lime juice for favour.

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